Organizational AI Use Policy Starter

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

This is a conversation starter, not a policy. In one study's general-workforce sample, 69% of professionals mention the social stigma that comes with using AI at work, and many conceal their use from colleagues. This scaffold helps you start a conversation about shared AI use norms. You are proposing shared standards, not asking for permission.

When an MIT committee was charged in 2026 with proposing institution-wide AI policy, it rejected a single rule as too permissive for some contexts and too restrictive for others. It recommended instead a shared framework: a policy menu, disclosure expectations, and accountability standards that each department adapts[1]. The four areas below are that framework at team scale.

HOW TO USE

1. Review the four areas below. **2.** Draft your "Your input" answers. **3.** Bring to a 1:1 or team meeting. **4.** Use as conversation structure, not a form.

1. DELEGATION NORMS

What tasks are appropriate for AI use on this team?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Appropriate tasks	Which types benefit from AI? (drafting, summarizing, translation, data compilation, brainstorming, formatting, calculations run through code or a calculator tool…)
Off-limits tasks	Where should AI not be used? (client-confidential, regulatory, personnel decisions, work that turns on empathy or in-person judgment…)
Data boundaries	What info can/cannot be shared with AI tools? (proprietary, client, internal strategy…)
Tool selection	Which AI tools are approved or preferred?

Expect disagreement at the boundary. When MIT's 2026 community survey asked which uses of AI in research were acceptable, the committee reports that most respondents accepted help with spelling and grammar, literature searches, and code. Most rejected AI for peer-reviewing manuscripts or drafting manuscript paragraphs from notes. The committee notes that people disagree on what 'support' means, so it recommends stating which uses are and are not allowed[2].

YOUR INPUT

I currently use AI for ___. I avoid it for ___. I'd like clarity on ___.

2. DISCLOSURE NORMS

What transparency is expected?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Internal work	What disclosure for internal deliverables? (None? Verbal? Written?)
Client-facing	What disclosure for external or client-facing deliverables?
Threshold	Stakes level below which disclosure isn't necessary?
Format	Diligence statement, footnote, verbal note, or team documentation? Precedent: MIT's 2026 AI committee recommends that every thesis state how AI was used and that AI never be listed as a co-author. It also recommends that instructors who present content substantially generated by AI, or use AI in evaluation or feedback, disclose how and why[3].

YOUR INPUT

I currently disclose by ___. I'm unsure about disclosure for ___.

3. VERIFICATION NORMS

What review standard applies?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Minimum standard	What verification before sharing? (spot-check? full review? peer review?)
High-stakes work	Deliverable types needing extra verification? (client-facing, financial, legal)
Accountability	Who's accountable for errors: delegator, reviewer, or both? Some workers skip verification because they see it as someone else's job (11 of 319 in one survey), and some because they lack the time (44 of 319; one cited a daily sales quota)[4]. A norm has to answer both.
Escalation	If an error reaches a client or stakeholder, how is that handled?

YOUR INPUT

I currently verify by ___. I'd like agreement on the standard for ___.

4. DOCUMENTATION NORMS

How is AI use recorded on this team?

TOPIC	DISCUSSION PROMPT
Team visibility	Track at individual, project, or team level?
Learning sharing	How do members share effective practices? (channel, retros, docs) Researchers suggest presenting critical thinking about AI output as long-term skill development rather than a per-task audit, because workers engage in it when they aim to improve their skills[5].
Improvement	How to evaluate whether AI improves quality, not just speed? Organizations reporting significant AI returns are twice as likely to have defined processes to measure the impact of their AI initiatives[6].

YOUR INPUT

I'd find it helpful if our team ___ to share what's working.

STARTING THE CONVERSATION

If raising AI norms feels uncomfortable, that's the concealment dynamic. Three framing options:

Frame 1: Process improvement

"I've been thinking about how we could be more consistent in how we use AI tools. I put together some discussion points. Could we spend 10 minutes in our next 1:1?"

Frame 2: Quality standard

"I want to make sure my AI-assisted work meets the team's standards. Can we align on what verification and disclosure look like for our deliverables?"

Frame 3: Team learning

"I think several of us are using AI but figuring it out independently. Would it be useful to agree on shared practices so we can learn from each other?"

The goal is to replace private, uncoordinated AI use with visible, accountable team practice, not to create bureaucracy. Attach a reason to each norm. MIT's 2026 AI committee heard that AI rules were confusing and varied widely, and that policing unauthorized use harmed instructors' relationships with the people they teach. It recommends that every AI policy explain why use is required, permitted, or restricted[7].

Framework: 4D AI Fluency Framework, Diligence competency, Transparency sub-component (Dakan & Feller, 2025)[8], as taught in Anthropic's AI Fluency course[9]. Impact-measurement figure: McKinsey, The state of AI in 2026[6]. Some task examples: WEF Future of Jobs Report 2025[10] (an Indeed analysis based on GPT-4o's rating of its own abilities).

Notes

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2. MIT Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training, "Report of MIT's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training," Massachusetts Institute of Technology, August 2026, pp. 30, 33, https://sites.mit.edu/ai-use/files/2026/08/AI-Committee-Final-Report-Aug-13.pdf
3. MIT Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training, "Report of MIT's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training," Massachusetts Institute of Technology, August 2026, pp. 20, 22, https://sites.mit.edu/ai-use/files/2026/08/AI-Committee-Final-Report-Aug-13.pdf
4. Hao-Ping (Hank) Lee et al., "The Impact of Generative AI on Critical Thinking: Self-Reported Reductions in Cognitive Effort and Confidence Effects From a Survey of Knowledge Workers," Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 2025, p. 11 (awareness, motivation, and ability barriers; trivial task 55/319; trust 83/319; time 44/319; barriers to inspecting responses, such as limited domain knowledge, 58/319; barriers to revising queries and improving output 72/319), https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3713778
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7. MIT Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training, "Report of MIT's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training," Massachusetts Institute of Technology, August 2026, pp. 5, 16–17, https://sites.mit.edu/ai-use/files/2026/08/AI-Committee-Final-Report-Aug-13.pdf
8. Rick Dakan and Joseph Feller, "Framework for AI Fluency: Practical Overview Document (Version 1.1)," Ringling College of Art and Design; University College Cork, January 2025, p. 6, https://ringling.libguides.com/ai/framework
9. Rick Dakan, Joseph Feller, and Anthropic, "AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations (course)," Anthropic Academy, 2025, https://anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-framework-foundations
10. World Economic Forum, "The Future of Jobs Report 2025," January 2025, pp. 43–44, Box 3.1, https://reports.weforum.org/docs/WEF_Future_of_Jobs_Report_2025.pdf

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